

How to Clean and Lubricate a Bike Chain

A clean bike chain ensures smooth gear shifting for a better riding experience and extends the life of your bicycle's drivetrain.

- Step 1. Lift the bicycle's rear wheel into the air.
- Step 2. Suspend the wheel using a bike stand.
- Step 3. Rotate the pedals forward with one hand.
- Step 4. Click the shifter on the right handle of the bicycle.
- Step 5. Continue until the chain is on the smallest, outermost gear.
- Step 6. Place the bicycle down.
- Step 7. Lean the bicycle's left side against a wall.
- Step 8. Apply a small amount of degreaser to a rag.

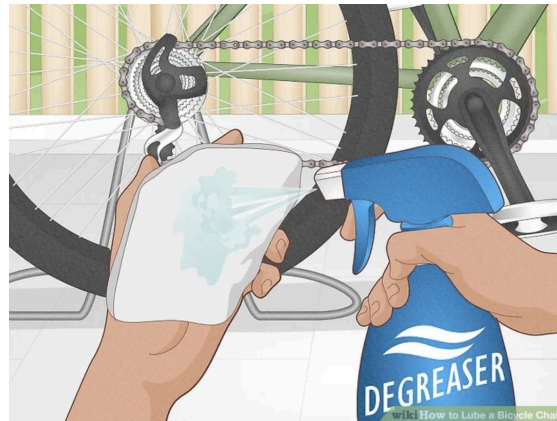


Figure 1. Applying degreaser to a clean rag. (Source: [WikiHow](https://www.wikihow.com/How-to-Lube-a-Bicycle-Chain))

- Step 9. Wrap the damp rag around the lower section of the chain.
- Step 10. Grip the rag firmly with one hand.
- Step 11. Rotate the right pedal backward with your other hand.
- Step 12. Rotate for five full cycles.

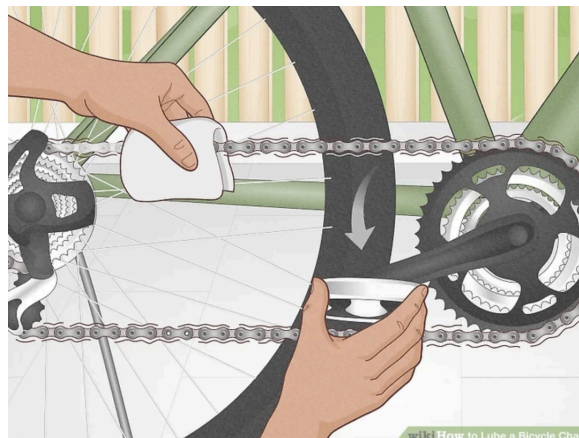


Figure 2. Rotating chain. (Source: [WikiHow](#))

- Step 13. Wipe the chain with a clean, dry section of the rag.
- Step 14. Identify one singular segment of the chain, called a “link”.
- Step 15. Find the small metal cylinder in the center of that link.
- Step 16. Squeeze one drop of oil onto the link.
- Step 17. Turn the pedals counterclockwise to reach the next link.
- Step 18. Continue oiling each link of the chain until the chain is fully lubricated.

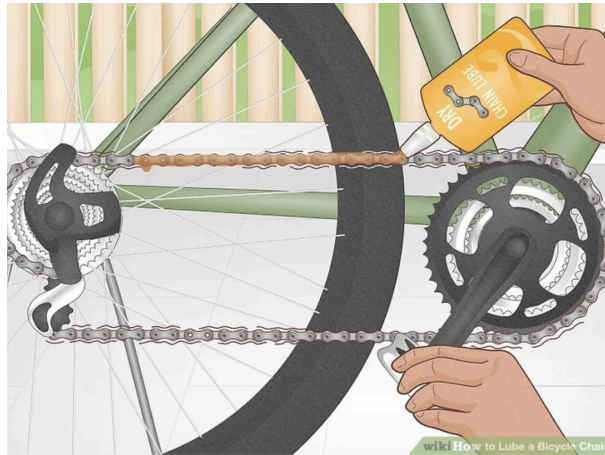


Figure 3. Applying lubricant to chain. (Source: [WikiHow](#))

- Step 19. Wait five minutes for the oil to soak into the links.
- Step 20. Wipe the outside of the chain with a clean rag to remove excess oil.